Nicholas Brown

Interdisciplinary Center for Economic Science, George Mason University
nbrown38@gmu.edu • (575) 607-6067 • www.nickraybrown.com

Research Interests

Committees, Voting, Competitive Games

Education

Ph.D., Economics, George Mason University 2021–2027 (expected)
M.A., Economics, George Mason University

B.S., Mathematics; **B.S., Economics**, Texas Tech University 2017–2021

Job Market Paper

Expressive Motivations in Committees
with Daniel Houser and César Martinelli

Why do committee members with little information potentially harm the quality of a committee's decision by speaking? We run laboratory experiments where subjects can acquire information about the correct state of the world, communicate, and vote (with the goal of choosing the correct alternative). Contrary to the simple game theory prediction that subjects should truthfully report their information to the group, subjects frequently report information after not gathering any. Using a logit quantal response equilibrium we find that observed behavior is consistent with a desire to report signals to the group (even if the report is untrue) and a desire to tell the truth.

Working Papers

Price Distortions and Hoarding: An Experiment
Edgar Castro, César Martinelli, and Nicholas Brown. BEER Working Paper 2026-02

We study how current and anticipated price distortions affect storage decisions in a two-period model. Both anticipated rationing and anticipated price liberalization create incentives to hoard, though for different reasons. We test these predictions in the laboratory using three treatments: a free market with rising costs, an anticipated price cap, and liberalization following a price cap. The model successfully predicts the broad patterns of shortages and prices across treatments. Under liberalization, shortages become increasingly severe as participants gain experience with the regulated market, and prices more than double once the cap is lifted. When a price cap is anticipated, however, participants store less than predicted and bid too little for storage, as if they underestimate the severity of future rationing. Both price-control regimes entail substantial welfare losses with respect to the free market, with liberalization producing the lowest surplus as rent-seeking rather than defensive storage becomes the dominant motive for hoarding.

Mass Reproducibility in Psychological Science

Brodeur, Abdul Baki, Fazio, et al. (large-scale replication). I4R Discussion Paper No. 326

Concerns about the credibility and reproducibility of published findings have motivated numerous initiatives to improve transparency in psychology. In this article, we present evidence from a large-scale reproducibility initiative conducted in partnership between Psychological Science and the Institute for Replication (I4R). Our project systematically reproduces empirical results published in the journal between 2024 and 2025 using independent research teams. Through a combination of Replication Games and researcher-led initiatives, 67 independent teams examined 44% of the articles (i.e., 64 articles) published during our time frame, documenting data and code availability, checking for coding errors, and deviations from preregistration, and computationally reproducing the main numerical results. We find that the majority of articles provide cleaned data and analysis scripts, though raw data and data-cleaning scripts are shared far less often. Computational reproducibility depends strongly on the starting point: 58.2% of articles are fully reproducible from final analysis data, but only 28.4% are fully reproducible from raw data. Teams identify coding errors or statistical reporting inconsistencies in 63% of articles, although most issues are minor; 40.5% of the articles flagged with coding or statistical reporting issues contain discrepancies with potentially major implications for estimates or interpretation. Preregistration is common (74.6% of articles), yet 84% of preregistered articles deviate from their pre-analysis plan, and nearly half of these deviations go unacknowledged. Our findings provide new insights into the reliability of empirical results in a leading psychology journal and highlight the value of structured mass reproducibility initiatives.

Work in Progress

Identifying Exploitability and Exploitation

Minimax Play at Adam's Smash Series (data collection in progress)

Presentations

Conference Presentations

Economic Science Association — *Expressive Motivations in Committees* Nov 2026

Midwest Economics Association — *Inattentive Jurors: Experimental Evidence* Mar 2026

Association of Private Enterprise Education — *Inattentive Jurors: Experimental Evidence* Feb 2026

Southern Economic Association — *Inattentive Jurors: Experimental Evidence* Nov 2025

Association of Private Enterprise Education — *Towards a Unified Theory of Currency: Substitution and Dollarization* Apr 2024

ICES Brown Bag Seminars, George Mason University

Expressive Motivations in Committees — Oct 2026
Inattentive Voters: Experimental Evidence — Nov 2025
Credible Punishment in a Public Goods Game — Oct 2024
A Model of Reputation-Motivated Vote Trading and Its Implications — Apr 2024

Fellowships and Awards

SEA Graduate Student Award, Southern Economic Association — 2026
Osher Lifelong Learning Institute Scholarship — 2026
APEE Young Scholars Program — 2024, 2026
ICES Graduate Fellowship (funding all six years) — 2021–2027

Teaching Experience

Instructor, George Mason University

ECON 306: Intermediate Microeconomics (asynchronous online) — Summer 2026
ECON 385: International Economic Policy (in person) — Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant, George Mason University

ECON 886: Game Theory (PhD), for César Martinelli — Fall 2023, 2024, 2026
ECON 103: Microeconomic Principles, for César Martinelli — Spring 2024

Workshops Organized

Pre-ESA Presentation Workshop, George Mason University — Oct 2026
Plastic Bag Series (with Aleksander Psurek), monthly — Spring 2024

Professional Service

Referee: *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*

References

César Martinelli
George Mason University
cmarti33@gmu.edu

Daniel Houser
George Mason University
dhouser@gmu.edu

Johanna Mollerstrom
George Mason University
johanna.mollerstrom@gmail.com